NORTHFIELD BUSINESS SCHOOL

CONFIDENTIAL

MARKETING PLAN

STRATEGIC MARKETING PLANNING

Brew & Bloom

A 12-Month Marketing Plan for a Speciality Coffee Subscription

How a small-batch roaster turns a loyal local following into a national subscription business — without discounting the craft.

PREPARED BY
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ORGANISATION
Northfield Business School

PREPARED FOR
Brew & Bloom Ltd.

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Executive summary

Brew & Bloom is a speciality coffee roaster with two cafés and a growing wholesale account base. The business has earned a strong local reputation but has not yet converted that reputation into recurring revenue. This plan sets out how we will launch and scale a **coffee subscription** over the next twelve months, moving from one-off purchases to predictable monthly income.

The opportunity is clear. Subscription coffee is growing faster than the wider speciality market, and our existing customers already buy from us every week. The constraint is not demand — it is that we have never asked for the second purchase in a structured way.

MONTHLY RECURRING REVENUE	ACTIVE SUBSCRIBERS	CUSTOMER ACQUISITION COST
£18,400	640	£24
target	target	−32%

AVERAGE ORDER VALUE	CHURN (MONTHLY)
£31	4.2%
+14%	−1.8pts

THE ONE-SENTENCE STRATEGY

Sell the habit, not the bag: position the subscription as a monthly ritual that removes a small decision from the customer's week.

Where we are today

Two cafés generate steady footfall but thin margins. Wholesale is profitable but concentrated in four accounts, which is a risk. Online sales exist but are treated as an afterthought: a single product page, no email capture, and no reason to return.



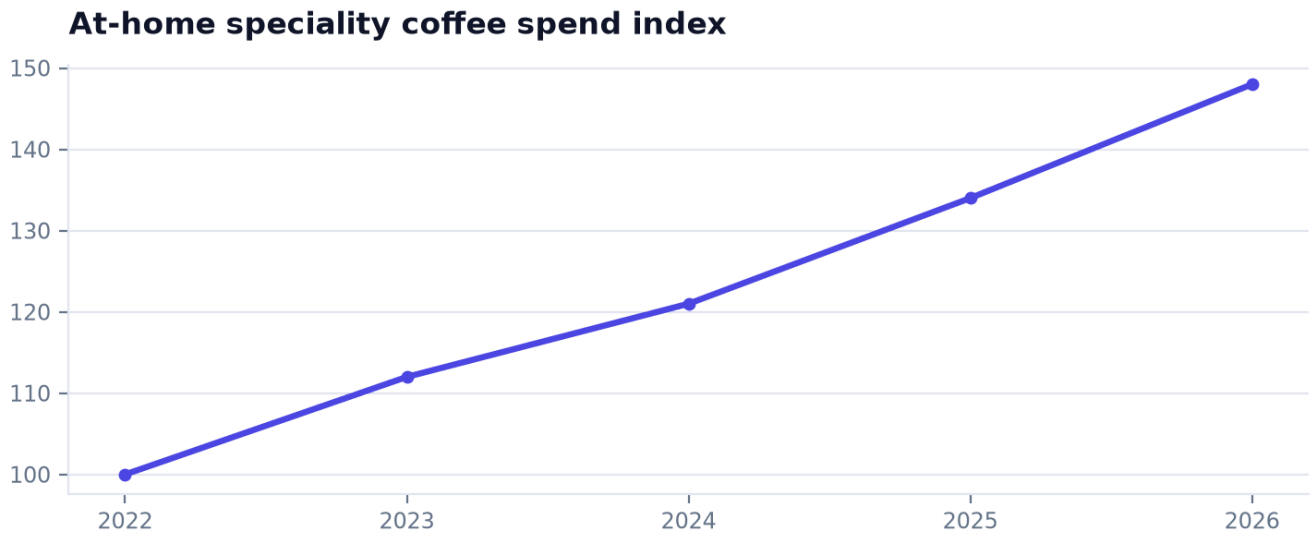
Fig. 1 Speciality coffee being poured at a café counter

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Current marketing situation

Market analysis

The UK speciality coffee market continues to premiumise. Consumers are increasingly comfortable paying for provenance, and the at-home brewing category has held onto the habits formed when cafés were closed. Subscription boxes have moved from novelty to routine for a meaningful segment of urban professionals.



At-home speciality coffee spend index

The trend matters because it shifts the question from *"can we sell more coffee?"* to *"who will let us choose their coffee for them every month?"*

Competitor analysis

COMPETITOR	POSITIONING	PRICE / MONTH	WEAKNESS WE CAN EXPLOIT
National Box Co.	Convenience, wide choice	£18	Generic beans, no local story
Grind House Club	Third-wave credibility	£28	Poor onboarding, high churn
Supermarket own-brand	Price	£9	No freshness, no ritual
Brew & Bloom	**Local craft, monthly ritual**	**£24**	**Small brand awareness**

Our advantage is not price. It is proximity, provenance, and the fact that a real person roasts the coffee and writes the tasting note.

Customer analysis

Three segments matter:

1. **The local regular (43%)** — already visits weekly, high trust, low acquisition cost. The easiest first subscriber.
2. **The gift buyer (31%)** — seasonal, price-insensitive, buys for others. Strong in November and December.
3. **The remote professional (26%)** — wants convenience and quality, discovers us through search and social, most likely to churn if the first box disappoints.

SWOT and issues

SWOT

STRENGTHS

- Roastery ownership and freshness
- Strong repeat footfall
- Authentic origin story

WEAKNESSES

- Low brand awareness outside the city
- No email list or CRM discipline
- Single-product website

OPPORTUNITIES

- Subscription growth in at-home brewing
- Corporate gifting in Q4
- Wholesale expansion into offices

THREATS

- National competitors cutting prices
- Green bean price volatility
- Rising delivery costs

Key issues

THE CENTRAL ISSUE

We have earned trust in person and have no mechanism to carry that trust online. Every week we serve customers we cannot reach again.

Objectives

Objectives follow the SMART discipline and are set for twelve months from launch.

OBJECTIVE	METRIC	BASELINE	TARGET	DEADLINE
Grow recurring revenue	MRR	£0	£18,400	Month 12
Build a subscriber base	Active subscribers	0	640	Month 12
Capture demand we already have	Email list	1,200	9,000	Month 6
Keep churn healthy	Monthly churn	—	≤ 4.5%	Ongoing
Protect margin	Gross margin	58%	62%	Month 12

Marketing strategy

Positioning

For urban professionals who care about what they drink but do not want to research it, **Brew & Bloom is the local roaster that chooses your coffee for you** — because a monthly ritual should feel handled, not homework.

Targeting

We will sequence the segments rather than serve them all at once. The local regular validates the product and generates testimonials; the gift buyer funds Q4 acquisition; the remote professional becomes viable only once retention is proven.



Fig. 2 A flat lay of coffee beans, a grinder and a brewing scale

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The marketing mix

Product

Three tiers, differentiated by cadence and curation rather than volume:

- **The Weekly** — 250 g, one origin, £12
- **The Ritual** — 500 g, two origins, £24 *(hero product)*
- **The Cellar** — 1 kg, rotating reserve, £46

Price

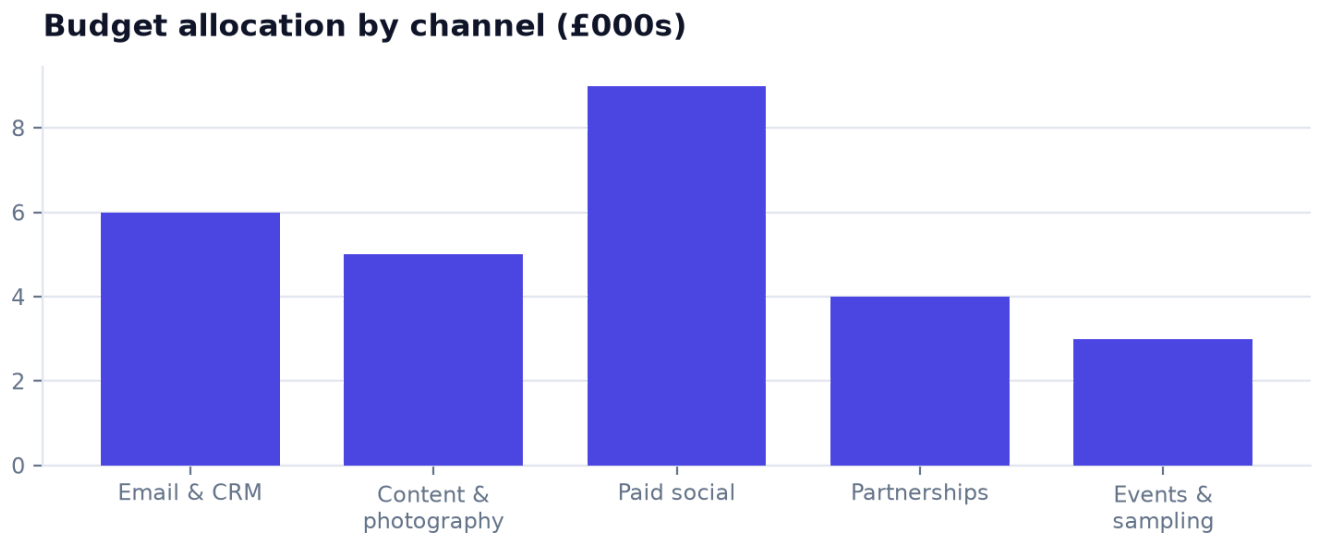
Priced at a premium to supermarket coffee and slightly below third-wave competitors. No launch discount; instead, the first month includes a free brew guide, which protects perceived value.

Place

The website becomes the primary conversion surface. Cafés act as physical proof and referral points; wholesale becomes a corporate subscription channel.

Promotion

Earned media and email first, paid social second. We will invest in the story — the farm, the roast, the person — because that is the only story a national competitor cannot copy.



Budget allocation by channel (£000s)

Action programs

Q1 — Foundations

- Rebuild the subscription landing page around a single call to action.
- Instrument email capture in both cafés with a QR code and a small incentive.
- Photograph the roastery and the founding story for reuse across channels.

> **OWNER AND DATE**
>
> Owner: Marketing lead. First review: end of January.

Q2 — Launch and learn

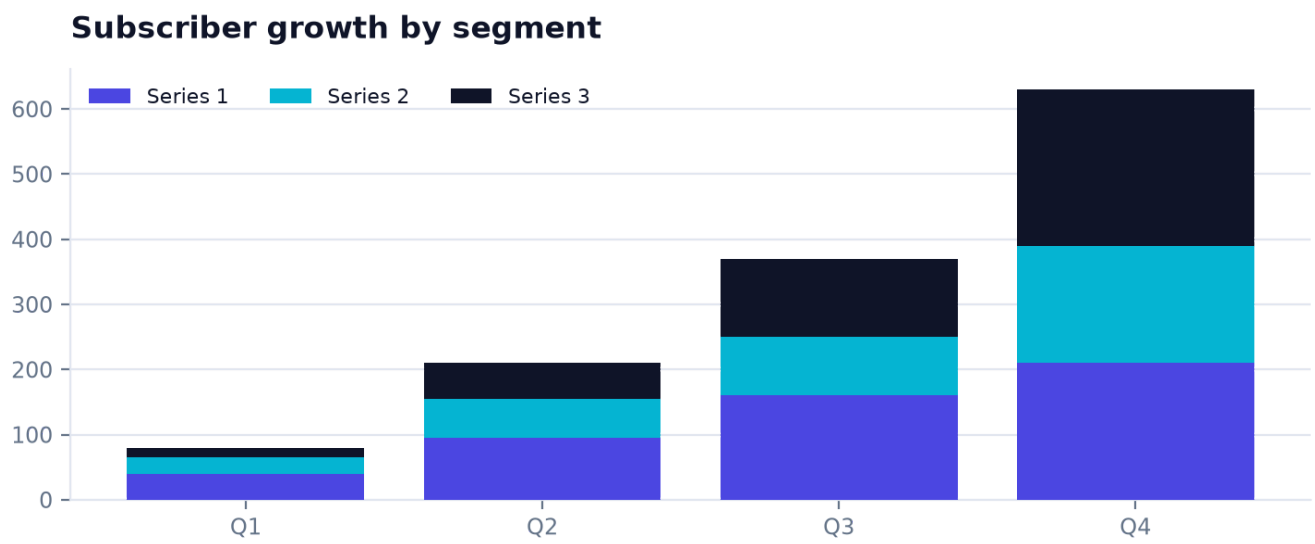
- Launch the three tiers to the existing email list before any paid spend.
- Run a referral programme: one free box for the referrer, one for the friend.
- Begin a fortnightly “roast note” email, written by the roaster.

Q3 — Scale what works

- Move paid social budget to the two best-performing creative concepts.
- Open a corporate gifting page for Q4 pipeline.
- Introduce a win-back flow at the point of cancellation.

Q4 — Gifting and retention

- Launch the gift subscription with a printed card.
- Run a subscriber-only tasting evening in the café.
- Publish a transparent “year in coffee” report as a brand asset.



Subscriber growth by segment



Fig. 3 An independent coffee roastery interior with sacks of green beans

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Budget

LINE ITEM	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	TOTAL
Email & CRM tooling	1,500	1,500	1,500	1,500	6,000
Content & photography	2,000	1,000	1,000	1,000	5,000
Paid social	1,500	2,500	2,500	2,500	9,000
Partnerships	500	1,000	1,250	1,250	4,000
Events & sampling	500	750	750	1,000	3,000
Total	**6,000**	**6,750**	**7,000**	**7,250**	**27,000**

The plan is cash-positive by month nine on a conservative conversion assumption of 2.1% of the email list.

Controls

Measurement

We will review a single dashboard monthly against five numbers: MRR, active subscribers, churn, CAC, and gross margin. Anything outside tolerance triggers a written review within two weeks.

Review cadence

CADENCE	FORUM	DECISION RIGHTS
Weekly	Marketing stand-up	Creative and channel tactics
Monthly	Performance review	Budget reallocation up to 10%
Quarterly	Strategy review	Pricing, tiers, and segment focus

> **TRIGGER FOR A RETHINK**
>
> If monthly churn exceeds 6% for two consecutive months, we pause paid acquisition until the onboarding and first-box experience is fixed.

Risks and mitigations

RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION
Green bean price spike	Medium	High	Forward contracts; review pricing quarterly
Delivery cost inflation	High	Medium	Minimum order value; local pickup option
Churn above target	Medium	High	Onboarding call; win-back flow; pause option
Brand awareness stays low	Medium	Medium	Partnership-led reach; local press

IMAGE CREDITS

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Ready to brew something bigger?

This plan is a working document. It will be reviewed at the end of each quarter against the control metrics in Section 8.

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